Demand request: Supplier onboarding workflow

Demand ID: D-2026-320
Demand title: Supplier onboarding workflow
Date submitted: 2026-09-14
Requesting department: Procurement
Requester role: Head of Supplier Management
Business sponsor: Chief Procurement Officer

Business need

Procurement onboards about 40 new suppliers a year, three or four a month. Each onboarding involves four teams: Procurement (company documents, 6 people), Finance (bank details, 4 people), Legal (contract terms, 3 people) and Information Security (a data access review, 2 people). All four steps are handled by email, so about 15 people work on a supplier with no shared view of where it stands.

In the last two quarters, 3 of 19 suppliers waited more than six weeks because a document sat unanswered in one person's inbox; our target is 15 working days. In the last 12 months two payments went to outdated bank details, about 35,000 each, both recovered only after three weeks. Finance had keyed the details by hand from an emailed PDF.

We need a workflow that (1) opens a supplier record when Procurement accepts a request; (2) routes it through the four checks in order, with Information Security only when the supplier will access company data; (3) shows everyone involved the current status and who holds the next step; (4) reminds the owner of a step that has waited more than five working days and tells the Head of Supplier Management after ten; and (5) records each approval with its date and approver. It must read supplier bank details from the Finance system and contract terms from the Contract Register, so that nobody keys them in again.

Expected outcome

The median onboarding time falls from 31 working days to under 15, and no supplier waits longer than 20 working days. No payment goes to outdated bank details (two in the last year). About 120 hours a year of Procurement and Finance time is saved, roughly 3 hours per supplier now spent chasing documents.

Request type: New solution. Requester urgency: Medium. Target go-live: 2027-03-01.

Timing: the annual contract round starts on 1 March 2027. If the workflow is not live by then, the 2027 round will repeat the manual process for about 12 suppliers.

Systems and data: the Contract Register, the Finance system (supplier master data and bank details) and email. The data involved is supplier company documents and bank details, which we classify as Confidential.